Information Security Policy

Document SEC-POL-01, version 2.3 - Effective 1 November 2024

Owner: Security Team

1. Purpose and scope

This policy explains how everyone at Kitewing must protect company, customer and employee information. It applies to all employees, contractors and temporary staff in every country, and to every device used for Kitewing work.

2. Data classification

Kitewing classifies information into four levels. Public information has been approved for release outside Kitewing, such as our website and published blog posts. Internal information is for Kitewing staff only, such as policies and team plans. Confidential information could harm Kitewing or our customers if it leaked, such as customer data, contracts and source code. Restricted information is the most sensitive, such as salary data, compensation bands, health information and security keys; access is limited to named people who need it for their job.

Confidential and Restricted information must only be stored in approved company systems. It must never be copied to personal email, personal cloud storage or USB drives.

3. Acceptable use

Kitewing devices and accounts are provided for work. Limited personal use is allowed if it does not interfere with your work or break this policy. Do not install unapproved software; request new software through Form IT-311 in KiteDesk.

4. Device security

Full-disk encryption (FileVault on Mac, BitLocker on Windows) must stay switched on at all times. Your screen must lock automatically after 5 minutes of inactivity. Install operating system updates within 14 days of release. Devices that fail a compliance check are blocked from the corporate network until they are fixed; the IT Support Guide lists the error codes you may see.

5. Passwords and multi-factor authentication

Passwords must be at least 14 characters long. Use the company password manager and never reuse your Kitewing password on another website. Multi-factor authentication (MFA) is required for every Kitewing system that supports it.

6. Reporting security incidents

If you click a link in a phishing email, enter your password on a suspicious website, open an unexpected attachment, or lose a device, act quickly. Speed matters more than certainty: report anything you are unsure about.

Step 1: Disconnect your device from the network by turning off Wi-Fi or unplugging the cable. Step 2: Do not delete the suspicious email; the Security Team may need it. Step 3: Report the incident within 1 hour by submitting Form IT-412 (Security Incident Report) in KiteDesk. Outside office hours, call the IT Helpdesk on extension 4357 and choose option 9. Step 4: If the Security Team asks you to, change your password from a different, trusted device.

You will not be disciplined for reporting a mistake promptly. Hiding an incident, or delaying a report, is a breach of this policy.

7. Using AI tools

You may use the approved Kitewing AI Assistant for work. Never paste Confidential or Restricted information into public AI chatbots or other AI tools that have not been approved by the Security Team. Always check AI-generated content before you rely on it or share it.

8. Sharing information with third parties

Confidential information may only be shared with a supplier, partner or customer when a signed non-disclosure agreement is in place. Restricted information may never be shared outside Kitewing without written approval from the Security Team and the information owner.

9. Travelling with devices

Keep your laptop in your hand luggage and never leave it unattended in a car. Before travelling to a country on the restricted travel list, collect a loaner laptop from IT and leave your usual laptop at home. The restricted travel list is published by the Security Team on The Perch.

10. Keeping and deleting information

Keep information only for as long as it is needed. Customer data is deleted 90 days after a customer contract ends, unless the law requires us to keep it longer. Employee records are kept for 6 years after someone leaves Kitewing.

11. Clean desk and printing

Lock your screen whenever you leave your desk. Do not leave Confidential or Restricted documents on desks or printers. Use the secure shredding bins in each office.